

DIET IN GASTRO INTESTINAL AND LIVER DISORDERS

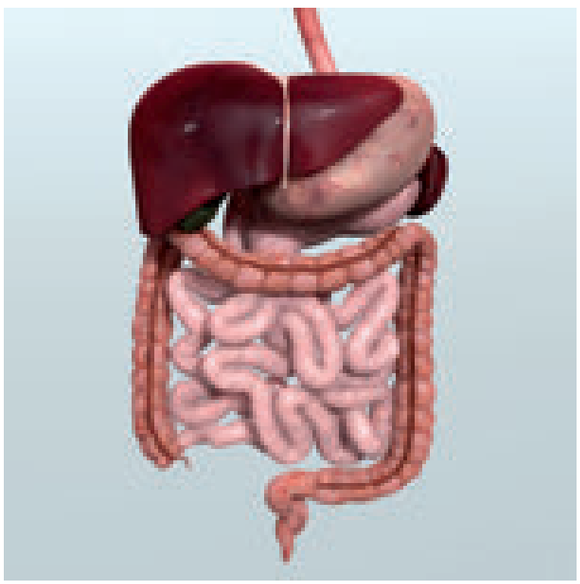
CHAPTER 8

OBJECTIVES

This chapter will enable students

- To understand the functions of gastrointestinal system
- To learn and understand the causes, symptoms and diet therapy for diarrhea, constipation and peptic ulcer.
- To understand the functions of liver
- To learn and understand the causes, symptoms and diet therapy for hepatitis and cirrhosis

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8.1 GASTROINTESTINAL DISORDERS

The gastrointestinal tract is an active organ which digests and modifies the nutrients for absorption. Gastro intestinal tract acts in unison with its glands and accessory organs like liver, pancreas and gall bladder to carry out the process. Gastrointestinal diseases refer to diseases involving gastrointestinal tract that is esophagus, stomach, small intestine and large intestine and accessory organs of digestion.

Functions of Gastrointestinal Tract

The gastro intestinal tract consists of esophagus, stomach, small intestine and large intestine. The functions of gastrointestinal system are:

- Ingestion of food,
- Propulsion of food,
- Digestion and absorption of food and
- Excretion of waste products.

The diseases of the upper gastrointestinal tract interfere with the intake of food by reducing appetite, inducing nausea and vomiting, evoking pain or by producing obstruction. The diseases of lower gastrointestinal tract impair the functions of intestinal tract and result in poor utilization of ingested food. The common disorders of stomach and intestine are diarrhoea, constipation and peptic ulcer.

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